Civil War Kiosk (1 of 5, Civil War, WWI, WWII, Spanish/American War, Cold War)
Themes: Media and the Message, Voices of Veterans, Databases, Technology Factors, Role of UP, Visitor Responses

The Role of Upper Michigan
(Images from MCHM collection, scanned and download free from
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HEADLINES are in BOLD

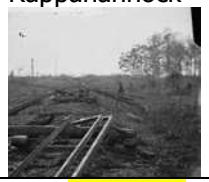
Theme	Image Ready	Audio	Status	Text on screen unless otherwise indicated
Voices of Veterans 1)	caption = Edward M. Watson file= Edward-watson			**Edward M. Watson** Watson entered the service as corporal in Company B, First Michigan Cavalry. He was wounded in action at Morristown, Tennessee and sent to Michigan to recruit. He returned to serve as lieutenant and captain in Company L, Ninth Cavalry. The J.M. Longyear Research Library has seventy letters written by Edward Watson between 1862 and 1864 to family members in Marquette. Watson uses humor in describing his harsh conditions and the challenges they faced.
		Watson - Food.mp3		**(script of audio file) Food** "After a week's work, the greater part of which has been the saddle, until yesterday our only food has been hard bread and coffee, the last only whenever we stayed in one place long enough to make it. But yesterday and today we have lived on the fat of the land. The boys make no bones about shooting a pig right in the street or exercising their sabers in cutting off the heads of chickens wherever they are to be found."
		Watson - Picket Duty.mp3		**(script of audio file) On Picket Duty** "After supper I was stationed at one of the outposts and sat in the saddle till daylight the morning. It was very tiresome work and along towards morning I got very cold and sleepy. In fact, I got so sleepy after a while that every time I shut my eyes to wink I would fall asleep and dream of a nice feather bed with warm blankets, before I could open them. I would wake up with a start when I found myself falling off my horse and grab for the saddle. Then I would promise myself not to go to sleep again but in less than five minutes in spite of running the risk of being shot by the rebels, or by our own men for being asleep on my post, I would find myself sliding off again."
	  File=Edward Watson1.jpg	Watson - First Shooting.mp3		**(script of audio file) First Shooting** "When I stood up for a mark the first time in my life for three fellows to get off from their horses and take aim over a rail fence at me, the first ball passes close to my head, the second fell short and the third struck the fence a little ways off. I hollered to the last one that he couldn't shoot worth shucks. His ball went way to the right. He answered back that he would do better next time, but when I pulled by carbine and sent a bullet in amongst them it would have made you laugh to see how quick they scattered and got on their horses and traveled."

	 File=Watson Record optional.jpg	Watson - July 1863.mp3		**(script of audio file) July 1863** "Because of the continual rain the company slept in a church.] As far as your humble servant was concerned, he had no fault to find what ever with his bed. Having had the pleasure before in times gone past of sleeping with a crowd, I couldn't see the propriety of indulging myself this time, and as the altar was unoccupied save by the large Bible generally found there, I concluded the place was good enough for me, so I took possession. They Bible and my two revolvers made a pretty good pillow, my horse blanket folded once made a soft bed and my coat over my shoulders made a good coverlid. I debated quite a while within myself as to whether I would remove my boots or not, but after considering the pros and cons all over, I came to the conclusion that if I should oversleep myself and someone should accidently happen to walk off in my boots that I should have to make the remainder of the journey barefoot. So for that reason I slept with them on."
Voices of Veterans 2)	Cwpb 01176 Union troops crossing the Rapidan River, May of 1864			**Albert Hoover "Hard Tack"** These letters were printed in the *Portage Lake Mining Gazette* and signed "Hard Tack." The soldier was from Capt. Moody's company. The writer may be Albert Hoover of Houghton. He enlisted as a private in Company B, 27th Michigan Infantry on August 11, 1862. He was promoted to first lieutenant, Company K and acting assistant commissary of subsistence. He was mustered out with the regiment on July 26, 1865.
	file=01173a.tif Cation= Ruins of the bridge 	Hardtack - we crossed rapidan.mp3		**(script of audio file) Crossing the Rapidan and Battle of the Wilderness** "We crossed the Rapidan [River] on the 5th inst., and on the 6th took part in the battle of Wilderness. This wilderness is a large tract of land covered with small trees and bushes principally fine/ and in places so dense as to prevent a passage through. We came upon the enemy about noon, connected our line, and, seeing a regiment in front, Major Moody gave orders not to fire until he gave the command. Our skirmishers were sent forward and had advanced but a few rods when this regiment in front poured a volley into our ranks, and then we saw they were rebels dressed in our clothes, and we paid them back with interest. The battle continued with great fury all the afternoon. About 3 o'clock P.M. the line of battle was formed [again] and we advanced on the rebels and drove them from two lines of breastworks. As we advanced our line was broken up and when our regiment halted we found ourselves almost alone there being few other regiments with us, the enemy seeing us thus unsupported and far in advance marched a column on our flank compelling us to fall back to a position a little in advance of where we started. Another charge was attempted later in the afternoon but the enemy having been reinforced, we could not dislodge them. The result of this day's fighting was highly gratifying to our side, the ememy having been driven at all points, instead of driving us as [General] Lee intended to do."
	File=samula-moody caption= Capt. Samuel Moody	Hardtack - capt Moody.mp3		**(script of audio file) Captain Moody** "Capt. Moody takes pleasure in acknowledging the receipt of frequent packages of the Gazette, which he distributes among the boys. We are grateful for the favor and return [to] you our hearty thanks. We married men would also tender our sincere thanks to the Supervisors County Clerk, and others interested in obtaining the county bounty due our families in Houghton County, for the promptness and attention they have exhibited in this department. While complaints are made from other sources, I have not heard any from the Houghton boys. The Regiment is very healthy, the medical department is managed with skill by experienced Surgeons."
Voices of Veterans 3.	 File=01846u-funeral of union.tif			**John B. LaVake** served in Sherman's march to the sea. He enlisted when he was 22 in June 13, 1862. His last battle was Atlanta, and he was discharged at Lookout Mountain, TN June 12, 1965. He was raised in Sault Ste. Marie and resettled in St. Ignace after the war. His grandfather was a lesser chief who signed the treaty with the Sioux and other tribes at Prairie du Chien, Wisconsin in 1825. He was a color bearer of the Fuller Post and died when he was 89.

	file= Indian sharp shooters.jpg 			**The Ojibwe - First Michigan Sharpshooters** Lake Superior News and Journal (of Marquette), May 29, 1863 Garrett A. Gravaraet (a metis) recruited many Ottawa and Ojibwe. Most of the men serving in Co. K were Indians from Michigan. Almost 2,000 of the 7,755 men who served were from the Upper Peninsula. While patriotism and loyalty to the US were invoked in their call for service, the reason for service seems to relate to their need to develop trust and leverage in maintaining their lands in Michigan. At the time, Michigan was rapidly being settled. Even with treaty agreements, attempts had been made to move the Ottawa to the West of Mississippi. The Regiment was involved in intense fighting from Spotsylvania to Crater, suffering great losses and being cited for heroism.
	file= census2 			Two Ojibwe men from Marquette volunteered for the 1st Michigan Sharpshooters: Thomas Wightman, enlisted on Aug. 19, 1863 for three years, age 37. Mustered, Company I, Aug. 28, 1863. Promoted to Corporal. Promoted to Sergeant May 1, 1865. Mustered out at Delany House, DC, May 28, 1865. Moses Williams, Enlisted July 4, 1863 for three years, age 30. Mustered, Company K, July 20, 1863. Killed in action July 30, 1863 at the Crater, VA. The 1890 Special Census of veterans and their survivors lists "George Madosh Indian." It gives no service record, but remarks, "I have applied for a Pension but never received any. I am destitute and need help."
	file= 	Indian sharpp shooters.jpgg		**Speech of a Loyal Indian to the Indians of the 1st Michigan Sharpshooters** Excerpts from *The Detroit Advertiser and Tribune*, July 11, 1863 The following speech of Nock-ke-chick-jaw-me, Chief of the Chippeways, was delivered to the Indian Company of the 1st Michigan Sharpshooters at Dearbornville, on Saturday by his special interpreter, Rev. H. Jackson, who has been interpreter for the Government….

	??? Record speaker In Porcess ???			**(script of audio file)** My children!—I have come a long way from the home of your fathers to see and counsel you; to see you on parade and in camp and learn if you behave like true sons and noble braves. Listen to my words and I will advise you.—You must obey the officers set over you; discharge every duty to our country; be loyal to our great father, the President of the United States…. Save your money. Your fathers are growing old. They are left behind and will need it—remember them in gratitude for the care and instruction given you. They would be sad to have you misdemean yourselves, for they respect the brave and valiant heroes who fight for their country and the right…. My children! You are young and inexperienced. I desire you to reflect on your duty.—Do not trifle. Understand for what you are fighting; be not boys, but brave and good men. You know but little of the history of our tribe. We are descendants of braves, who united with our younger brothers, the Ottawas, drove the powerful tribes now beyond the "great river" from these our once beautiful hunting grounds! The young men fitted themselves for warriors by the severest training and fasting, and confidence in the Great Spirit.—They listened to the words of their Chiefs and obeyed them. I desire you, my children, to listen to the instruction of your officers; learn you duty and do it, and like your ancestors, you will be heroic and brave. Have confidence in the Great Spirit, and when you die your forefathers will welcome you to the spirit land as brave sons…. As I sat in my wigwam I thought of you—I love you—I am full of joy and gratitude for this privilege of talking to you….I shall visit you and instruct you; and, if necessary, go South to watch and care for you. Do not desert. It will disgrace your people and bring punishment on your hands. Be faithful to your country, brave and valiant, and the Great Spirit will reward you.
Media and the Messa ge	Newspaper Scans: War Meeting REDO	(will email pic)		**Draft and Recruitment** At the Court house in Marquette, rallies were held and bounties were raised to meet the quota. The plan was to avoid the draft, which locals feared would harm the operation of the iron mines.
	file=IS Calvery.jpg 			The August 24, 1861 issue of *The Lake Superior News* of Marquette reported on the first of many groups of men to leave from the Lake Superior region on the Planet for Detroit to join the 1st Michigan Infantry. To date 150 had left from the region. While Peter White is listed, he did not leave, but felt his efforts were needed at home and so he paid $300 for a substitute. This was a legal exemption to the draft.
	Newspaper scan: recruitment REDO	(will email pic)		August 15, 1862 The paper reports several times throughout the war when Capt.s Moody and Truckey returned to recruit new volunteers. A total of 1,175 men served from the Upper Peninsula.

Media	Image-Scan: Dragging Artillery Over the Mountains			**War Correspondents** **Harper's Weekly** This weekly newspaper was a common way for the public to follow the war. Etchings of portraits, maps, and scenes of battles all illustrated the articles. Bound collections were made available following the war.
f	file= 888a.jpg caption= Gettysburg, Confederate Dead, Rose Farm, 1863			**Brady and Photography** The Michigan First Infantry fought and died here, including men from Marquette County. Photography was reaching the public at the time of the Civil War. Photography allowed the public to see battlefield scenes for the first time. Many photographers, notably Mathew Brady, Alexander Gardner, George Barnard and Timothy O'Sullivan documented the camps, towns, people and technology of war, like bridges. Cameras were still too bulky and slow to allow action photos.
	file= 1958.47.1 (7)			Even soldiers could afford to send home a keepsake for their family. This one is signed on the back "to Mother."
	file= 00170u-Brady-photo-outfit.jpg 			**Brady's photo outfit Petersburg, VA** During the Civil War, photography was complex and time consuming. Two photographers would arrive at a location. One would mix chemicals and pour them on a clean glass plate. After the chemicals were given time to evaporate, the glass plate would be sensitized by being immersed in darkness in a bath solution. The plate was then inserted into the camera, positioned and focused. The two had to complete the exposure and development within ten minutes. Next, the exposed plate was rushed to a wagon darkroom for developing. All this quick and careful handling of the glass plate was done on a battlefield.
	file= 1975.33.1 			**MUSIC** Young boys, such as the one pictured here, often served as musicians. Music was used for enlistment, during battles and at home. Military bands often played at recruitment rallies, using patriotic marching tunes to inspire young men to enlist. Drummers and fifers played to support the troops' spirits, even in the midst of battle. Drums communicated orders as well as morning wake up, roll call, guard duty. The Cavalry used buglers to share orders. Civil War songs which are sung today include "The Yellow Rose of Texas" and "When Johnny Comes Marching Home Again."
	News Paper scan (Emancipation Proc)	(will email pic)		In January 1863, Lincoln signed the Emancipation Proclamation which freed slaves in the Confederate states. After General Sherman's march through Georgia, in which this troops destroyed factories, bridges, railroads and public buildings and captured Atlanta, General Lee surrendered on April 9th of 1865 at the Appomattox Courthouse.

Technology	file=01188a.tif Caption= Confederate dead near Spotsylvania, VA May 1864. 	file=soldier pins 	(line up this>> comment with pic <<<)	**Dogtags** American soldiers during the Civil War were concerned that their identities be known should they die on the battlefield. There was no official form of identification such as "dog tags" so it was up to each man to identify himself. Some soldiers wrote their names and unit numbers on paper tags and pinned them to their uniforms. Others fashioned a tag out of wood which could be worn on a string around the neck. *Harper's Weekly* magazine advertised "Soldiers Pins" which could be ordered and worn. They were inscribed with the soldier's name and unit. Private vendors followed the troops and offered similar items for sale before major battles.
Technology	file=768a.tif Caption=Virginia Tracks destroyed…Bristow and Rappahannock 			**Railroad trains** The recent technology of railways became an important part of the war. Troops, materials and food were all moved, as well as materials for civilians to support the war effort. For this reason, they were often targeted. The South used trains to quickly move support troops to a battle. Eventually the North began to use rails, which it had more of and of a more consistent gauge. General Sherman trained 10,000 troops to repair tracks, so they could be back in use after 1 or 2 days. When Sherman's troops marched to Savannah, they pulled up ties and rails, set them on fire, then bent and twisted rails around trees. This crippled the South. Savage Station on the Richmond and York River Railroad, Headquarters of Gen. McClellan)
Role of Upper Michigan	File=1955.34.3 caption=Jackson Iron Company, Negaunee 1860s			**Iron Mining at Jackson Iron Company, Negaunee** During the Civil War, Michigan iron produced much of the arms. Iron was necessary for the development of the railway as well as nails, steam engines and bridges. The war, in turn, developed the iron mines; output grew from 45,430 tons in 1861 to196,256 tons in 1865.
Role of Upper Michigan	file= quincy-mine 1955.34.2 cation=Quincy Mine, Hancock MI			**Copper Mining** The Quincy Mine produced 1251 tons of copper in 1864. The Quincy was the top producer of the 34 mines in the Lake Superior region at this time. Copper was used in making percussion caps, buckles, and new telegraph lines. As the war continued, demand grew, increasing both the output and price of copper. 68 million pounds of copper came out of Michigan's Lake Superior mines during the Civil War. A war-time copper tariff also reduced copper imports.
Role of Upper Michigan	file=Burt brothers block Caption= Burt Brothers Block			**Life at Home** Burt Brothers Block, which burned in the fire of 1868, resided on South Front. While the price of goods rose during the Civil War, wages did not. Transportation costs were still high and included almost everything (from cattle, flour to apples and fabric).

	file= 1953-1-20(2) Keweenaw Co..	file= isle royale- rock harbor		**Jane Masters** Jane was born in Cornwall, England. After marrying, the new couple traveled to New York City. Curious about all the talk of the upper Great Lakes region, they traveled to the region. They lived briefly on Isle Royale where the small group of copper miners ran out of meat in 1852. They moved next to Northwest Mine (Delaware Location in the Keweenaw Peninsula) when the "war of Rebellion" broke out. Jane had a total of 16 children and lived to be 96 years old, and made the Keweenaw her home.
	file= battle.jpg	file= 'Masters- Feelings ran high"	(Will email this audio file)	(script of audio file) "Feelings ran high and 'The Union Forever[1] was on every tongue. In all the community there was but one rebel sympathizer, a Mr. Moss, who was an agent at the Delaware1 He often showed disdain for the North and, when the men strung a Union banner above and across the road, he would make a detour through the woods rather than pass under the starry flag. The men taunted him so much that he finally left the country."
	file= Good for sale 3.jpg	file = 'Masters- prices of commodities'	(Will email this audio file)	(script of audio file) "Prices of commodities were almost beyond reach but somehow we managed to eke out a living. Flour soared to $18 per barrel, calico sold at 85 cents a yard, and kerosene oil as high as 50 cents a gallon. But prices of the other foods were low and pork sold for 10 cents a pound. Tobacco was plentiful and the men never paid more that 5 cents a pound. The matter of clothing was not vexatious, but no attention was paid to style. The women made their children's clothes, dresses, pants and shirts, caps, and stockings and there was not a murmur if the fit was not proper. I remember buying three or four men's handkerchiefs with which to make aprons." "I recall a few young Englishmen who probably possessed the only fashionable clothes of the day. When they appeared after payday in their broadcloth suits, high hats, and other decorations, the single young women would look upon them with awe. But the men looked at them from another angle and when they came home that evening they had battered faces and bandaged heads
	file= Dr blacker caption=Dr. Blaker			**Aid to Soldiers** Dr. Blaker, who was stationed with the 23rd, asked for medical supplies.
	file= Soldiers aid			**Soldier's Aid** Local women met weekly to gather materials to support local troops. Items shipped included cotton and linen for bandages and checkerboards and books to keep up their spirits

	file= 1956.1.6(1) caption= USS Michigan			USS Michigan Warship in Marquette USS Michigan at the Spear Dock in Lower Harbor, commissioned in 1844; it was the first iron hulled ship of the US Navy. Rumors of confederate plots in Northern cities, brought this Civil War ship to Sault Ste. Marie, Marquette and Houghton. In Marquette and Houghton, the sailors broke up the striking miners. While copper and iron prices doubled during the war, miners' wages did not. Following the war, salaries and production began to drop leading the miners to strike. Area citizens began to panic when mining equipment and property were destroyed, railroad lines were torn up and rumors were heard of burning Marquette. When the USS Michigan arrived at Marquette's docks, Lt Commander Francis Roe armed the 130 sailors with pistols, rifles and two howitzer guns, and they rode railcars to nearby mining camps. The commander told the miners to return to work within 24 hours or the "encampment would be stormed by shot and shell and no questions would be asked or answered. There must be no more rioting, no more idleness and no more threats." The miners returned to work and several days later the warship headed to Houghton to face similar circumstances.
	file= 1921.2.17(10) caption= Marquette's Lower Harbor, ca 1865			The ship returned to Marquette to find the miners back on strike and blocking the rail. The 8th Veteran Reserve Corps was telegraphed, and they arrived in Negaunee by rail on July 15. The strikers were caught between the soldiers on one side and the sailors on the other, enabling the sailors to push through and end the strike. The three week long strike was ended and as soldiers returned home and flooded the labor market, labor unrest was ended for that time.
	file= discharge John Coles			**Arrival Home** Returning soldiers were sometimes welcomed home in the local paper. Here is a Coles and Sneeden are "Discharged".
	file=1958.47.1(21) caption=President Abe Lincoln			**Medical Care** In 1865 the Lincoln administration established the National Home for Disabled Volunteer Soldiers to help the thousands of Union soldiers wounded during the Civil War. These state veterans' homes provided medical and hospital treatment for all injuries and disease whether or not of service origin. Indigent and disabled vets were cared for at these homes.

	file=1958.47.1(26) caption= Soldier with injured foot			**Federal Pensions** The Civil War saw a big expansion in federal pensions. Pensions were in part a way to encourage volunteers. The amount a veteran or widow received depended both on rank and level of disability. With advances in medicine, the war allowed for more wounded to survive resulting in more veterans in need of care. The custom of providing for our veterans dates back to early colonial laws. The first National Pension Law was enacted in 1776. It offered half a year's wage to severely disabled veterans. Over time legislation expanded to include widows and orphans. The Civil War brought the greatest change to veterans and their families. In 1862, one year after the start of the war, the General Pension Act increased benefits expanded eligibility and made it easier to make claims.
	file= 1923.17.2 caption= GAR members, Marquette, 1890			The Grand Army of the Republic successfully lobbied for the Dependent Pension Act of 1890. This removed the need for service-related injuries to receive a pension. By 1906 old age alone qualified a veteran for a pension. Federal pensions were never given to Confederate veterans, although Confederate states developed their own pension system.
	file= 0534 land grant edwards			**Land Grants** In 1855, Congress approved granting Bounty Lands to military officers and soldiers. President Lincoln awarded Joseph W. Edwards and George C. Jones 160 acres in Marquette County near Republic.
	file=census1			**Veterans Census** A special census in 1890 documented the Veterans and their families. A page of Marquette County's special census from the JM Longyear Research Library.
	file= 1925.1.74(1)			**Grand Army of the Republic (GAR)** Parade of GAR ca. 1902 in Ishpeming.
	file=military-ball-program caption=GAR Military Ball Program, District of Washington			The GAR began for Union veterans in 1866 for fraternity, charity and loyalty. The President Lincoln had pledged care for "those who have borne the burden, his widows and orphans." However, the federal government had very little experience or knowledge to fulfill this promise.
	File=gar-reunion caption= E.R. Stiles Post, Hancock,1889 at Champion			**GAR Reunion** In Upper Michigan, a group called the Soldiers and Sailors Association of the Upper Peninsula began to organize in 1879. Representatives came from Baraga, Houghton, Keweenaw, Marquette and Ontonagon Counties. Members from there formed the GAR posts E.R. Stiles Post in the Copper Country and the Alfred Jackson Post began in Marquette in 1885. By joining the GAR, they hoped to bring more political leverage to their cause.

	file= Jackson record			**Naming Marquette GAR** Marquette's GAR post #300 is named after Lieutenant Albert T. Jackson, of 1st Michigan Cavalry, who died of wounds received at Winchester VA (on September 19, 1864) and died November 12, 1864. He is believed to be the only Civil War soldier buried at Park Cemetery who died in action.
	file= Gar check stubs			**GAR Relief Fund** $5 and $10 checks were issued to widows from the local GAR's relief funds. Nationally and locally the GAR provided relief to the wounded, widows and orphans. These checks continued throughout the survivor's life. In several states, the GAR established homes for veterans and orphans; these homes were later transferred to the federal government.
	file = 1983.15.10(1) 			Caption=11GAR members in Marquette with President Theodore Roosevelt (here for Newett libel trial) in 1913: Mr. Burt, John Dooley, Mr. Jellison, Mr. Bahrman, Allen Cowden, Addison Cole, E.C. Anthony, Court Moore, Anton Kruger, R. P. Byrne and Sam Byrne. (note: Roosevelt staid at 424 Cedar) The GAR grew into a social and political force around the country. By 1890, it had about half a million members across the nation. The Albert Jackson Post Memorial Book lists 107 members, some of whom enlisted from other areas and settled here later.
	file= 1969.40			**Beginnings of Memorial Day** The GAR also began the observation of Decoration Day, on May 30, which became known as Memorial Day. Veterans' graves were decorated with flowers. caption= Veterans Roy M. Spenser, Louis Gilmett, Walter J. Walsh, Memorial Day, 1930.
	file= 1921.1.197 			GAR veterans in a Memorial Day parade, ca. 1895 in front of the newly built City Hall in Marquette.
	file= 1999.1.89 caption= Brevet Brigadier-General Charles Waite			Awarding of Metals and Honors The rank of Brevet Brigadier-General was in part an honorary promotion recognizing gallant conduct or admirable service. The rank was difficult to receive during the war, but was commonly given at the close of the war. Over 1,000 officers were awarded this distinction during the Civil War. After the war as the army was downsized, the army had trouble placing so many top officers. Brevet Brigadier-General Charles Waite On April 2, 1865 Charles Waite of Rockland was awarded Brevet Brigadier-General U. S. Volunteers for conspicuous gallantry in the assault on Petersburg, Va. Charles Waite entered company A of the 27th Infantry as First Lieutenant and was commissioned and mustered on October 10, 1862. He was wounded in action at Spotsylvania, VA on May 12, 1864 and promoted to Caption of company E and eventually to Colonel on March 6, 1865. He was mustered out on July 26, 1865. He moved to Illinois after the war and became a successful merchant and banker; he died in 1898.

	File= Arlington House.jpg file= Arlington now.jpg caption= Arlington National Cemetery, Virginia Today over 250,000 US soldiers are buried here.			Original Arlington House The home was built as a memorial by George Washington's adopted grandson in 1802. Ownership passed to his daughter, but Robert E. Lee and his wife lived there at the time the Civil War began. They left, realizing they would probably never be able to return. When taxes were unpaid, the government took possession of the property. Military installations were set up around the estate, and in 1864 it was first used as a military cemetery. Brig Gen. Montgomery C. Meigs purposefully built a monument near the house in the rose garden with 1,800 Union casualties in order to make the house uninhabitable. The federal government also built a model farm community for 1,100 freed slaves there in 1863. Lee never returned or publicly tried to recover the home. Following Lee's death, Lee's eldest son, George Washington Curtis Lee (to whom ownership would have passed), claimed the government had illegally confiscated the property. In 1882 the US Supreme Court ruled in his favor, and the following year, Congress purchased the property for $150,000. Freedman's village was removed at that time. Arlington National Cemetery, Virginia Today over 250,000 US soldiers are buried here.